

PRD: Lesson transcript + video scrubbing

Author:

Alicia Chan

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Status: Implementation -

Slack channel: #corex-transcript-scrubbing

Description:

Provide a time-stamped transcript of the lesson to learners, as well as the ability to scrub to the place in the video by clicking on the timestamp.

Problem / Why / Hypothesis:

What is the user problem we're trying to solve?

- The only way for learners to review their lesson is by watching or listening to their videos
- The only way for a learner to review a concept from their lesson is by trial & error to find the right place in the video
- Reviewing lessons and lesson materials has been shown to significantly increase how much people learn and how well they learn it. It's a faster, better way to learn a language. See more: [PRD: Post-Lesson Review \(Mega wishlist\)](#)

What is the business problem we're trying to solve?

- Students don't have a compelling reason to return to Cambly aside from booking or attending their lessons and using other tools and resources to augment their English language learning experience.
- Lesson recordings are a key differentiator that Cambly offers learners; we can amplify the importance of reviewing the right snippets and insights for learners to make reviewing lesson materials more accessible and effective.

What is the problem with the existing situation?

1. The only way to review lesson material is by watching the recording.
2. In order to review specific concepts a learner must skip ahead or back (guess & check!) in the lesson video in order to review.

How will our proposed changes improve the situation?

1. On desktop, give the learner a transcript to read and search (ctrl+F) for specific keywords
2. On mobile, give the learner alternative ways to review (reading the transcript) and easily scan for places in the audio to review
3. Make it easy for a learner to review portions of a recording to work on challenging concepts

Impact:

Who is the user we're solving for?

- All Cambly learners

What % of the population is that segment?

- 100%

How severe is this problem?

- Unclear, as current lesson rewatching behavior is low
- This is likely due to a) low awareness of watching lesson recordings [GPP will tackle this with comprehension efforts], b) lack of usability of lesson recording tools, c) low accessibility (in history page and lesson history card on home dash, it's not obvious that lesson history rows are clickable)

How will success appear? Is it a behavioral metric? Is it reduction of a stated user pain point?

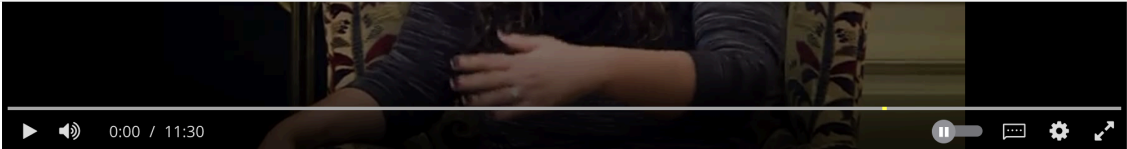
- Increased, repeat usage of lesson recordings

Changes:

1. Make the transcript available for a learner to read and search on screen.
 - a. Should show who is saying what
 - b. MVP: show transcript as is from our current model (which tries to fit all speech into English)
 - c. Future iterations (descoped for this project) would ideally be able to handle foreign languages:
 - i. Ideal state: Transcribe in the non-English language (see comps)
 - ii. Compromise: show that the speech was not comprehensible (in English) (see comps)

2. Make it possible for the learner to click on the part of the transcript and scrub to that part of the recording.





0:00 / 11:30

Part 2 - Money

[Save note](#)

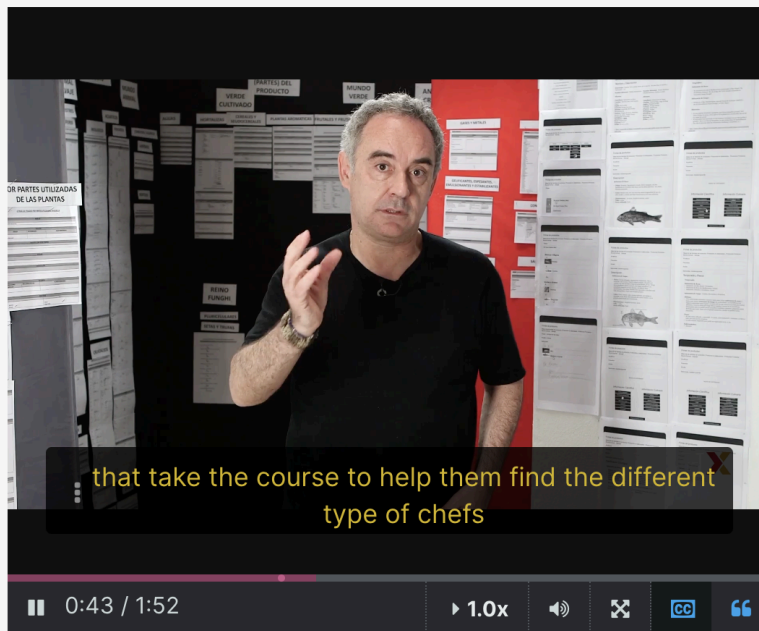
[Transcript](#) [Notes](#) [Downloads](#) [Discuss](#)

0:00 Because it seems when we're talking about getting a good job, one of the goals we're going for isn't really the good job, is getting lots of money. It's having wads of Benjamins where you could just go wherever you want and do that. We know this not just from what people are applying for in terms of their jobs. We know this in terms of how people spend money to try to get money. I'll give you one quick statistic. This is U.S. lottery spending in 2015. Anybody want to venture a guess in U.S. dollars, how much people spend on the lottery in general? No guesses. \$10 billion. \$10 billion. Actually seven times that. It's \$70 billion. And just to give you a sense of what that means, this is combined more than people spend on books, music, movie tickets, sports teams, and video games combined. So, this is like most forms of being excited about things around like people are spending on lottery tickets, why? Presumably, not because the lottery tickets are fun. Presumably, is they're getting, they're hoping to get more money. They're hoping to get lots of money. Those are just crazy people who spend money on lottery tickets. But can we see that sort of thing in you guys, in Yale students? Particularly in freshmen, we can look at that by looking at this one cool survey that researchers have done for a long time, which is known as the American



edX:

Ferran Adrià



about science and cooking in universities.

My role in this course more than anything

has been to help. To help and

support everything with my experience and knowledge

to help chefs

that take the course to help them find the different type of chefs

in the world

that are interested in the world of science and have made contributions to the world of science

and that have also, well, spread the word.

Because this is important its brilliant. I have a philosophy that is

Video

 [Download video file](#)

Transcripts

 [Download SubRip \(.srt\) file](#)

 [Download Text \(.txt\) file](#)



Search



 Sign in



i made a designer outfit with THEIR FABRIC 

Transcript

 Search in video

1:43 long s top the tight pants and then

1:45 hopefully i'm going to look like this in

1:47 the

1:48 end for some reason the patterns didn't

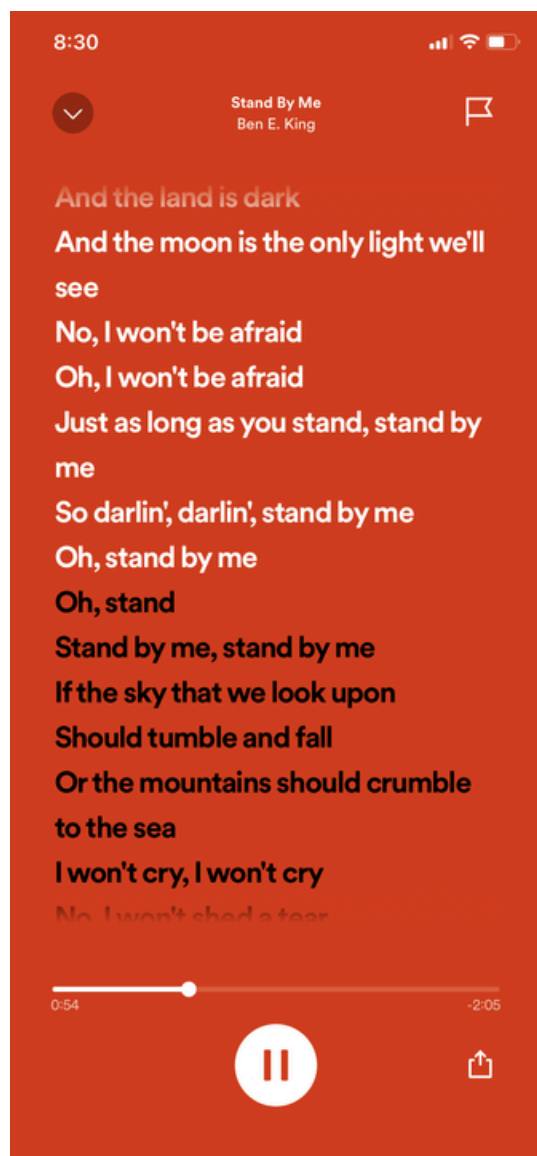
1:50 come with the fabric which kind of

1:52 strange so i actually have to make my

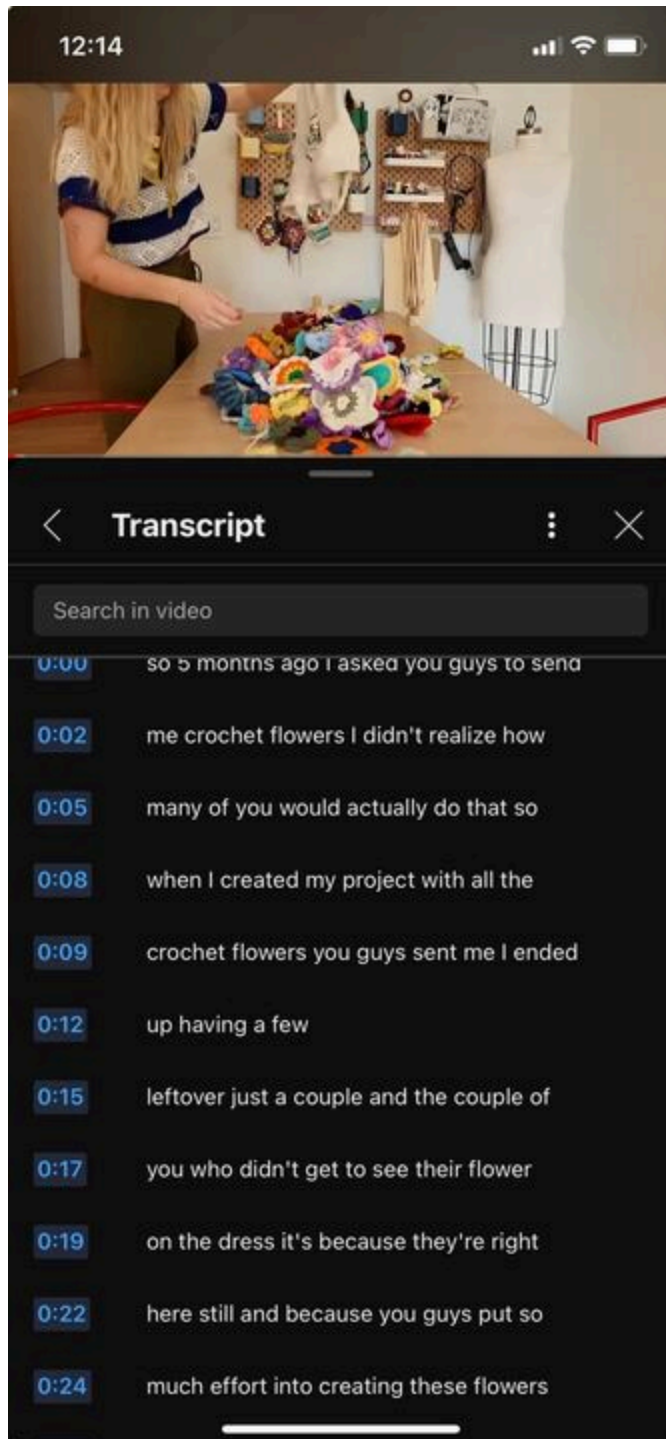
English (auto-generated)

 Just in: Free Dessert for Life

Mobile inspo - Spotify lyrics feature:



Youtube:



for ex

Current mobile view



3. Update the link from the post-lesson email CTA (Review Your Last Lesson) to link directly to the modal with the video player / chat transcript / lesson transcript

Figma:

[Link to Figma](#)

Tech Spec:

Link to tech design doc

Jira:

Link to Jira

Dependencies:

- PRD: Lesson transcript-based stats for Student Progress
- PRD: Students consume post-lesson tutor feedback
- Emojis and bookmarking in the classroom
- PRD: Slide playback alongside video

Success Metrics / KPIs:

What metrics will you watch to inform whether your experiment is successful or not?

- Substantial increase in [lesson video views](#)

Instrumentation Needs (PM to assess w/ Eng/PA)

What do we need to measure (including but not limited to Success Metrics)?

What existing data sources can we derive it from?

What new data sources do we need to create?

- Posthog logging on all platforms (web, ios, android):
 - Lesson video views (currently on web as lesson_history_play_video)
 - Lesson transcript views
 - Differentiate video views occurring from a timestamp other than the start
 - Views and clicks on other tabs (slides, messages)

GTM (PMM to assess):

To roll this product out (with GM support) we will need to:

- Post Lesson Review Positioning

Anticipated Impact on Tutor Teams (Tutors to assess):

What is the impact on tutors' day-to-day operations? n/a

What is the impact on tutors' accounting/financials? n/a

What is the impact on tutor policy and/or guidance? n/a

Will be a neat thing to inform tutors of but no major impact or required comms

Anticipated Impact on Support Teams (Support to assess):

- Green
- Will need to update current HC articles

Potential Legal Questions or Concerns (PRIVILEGED)

Is there anything about this initiative that should be flagged for a more in-depth legal review? Some quick examples (not exhaustive!):

- Log-in flow to make sure users are properly agreeing to terms;
- Initiatives that give more/less control to tutors (e.g., pay, scheduling, curriculum)
- Use/sharing of user data (e.g., recordings of sessions, behavioral advertising, etc)

- Changes to our GDPR/CCPA/LGPD/etc data-deletion/export process?
- Copyright or trademark concerns

When in doubt, just ask Amber for a quick review.

Key Dates:

When do we want to launch this experiment or feature? How long will we leave the experiment running for? Who else needs to know?

Target markets:

e.g. Turkey, Brazil

Launch checkpoint [mm/dd/yyyy]:

PM supports launch ▾

Eng supports launch ▾

Design no opinion ▾

Experiment size:

- 50/50, two weeks

Open Questions:

Result:

FAQ:

Notes:

Follow Up / Wishlist :

 = High priority

Web-specific

1. Update UI ([figma file](#))
2. Can we change cursor (from text behavior to button behavior) when hovering over clickable segment (similar to chat)
3. Video player randomly starts over (every ~1-2 min)
4. Autoscrolling
 - a. Doesn't respect user
 - ~~b. Scrubbing video doesn't take you to highlight~~
 - c. When scrubbing video I have to wait for scrolling to "catch up"
 - d. (^ related) ~~When I'm on another tab and go back to transcript tab, I have to wait for scrolling to "catch up" to current time~~
5. Highlight doesn't stay vertically centered in viewport

Mobile Specific

1. ~~(mobile) I think we broke chat scrubbing?~~
2. [cry emoji] I don't have an Android device...

All Platforms

1. We need a play button/video thumbnail (once video is loaded but not yet played)
2. When I scrub video playback bar it takes a few seconds for highlight to "snap" to time
3. (Chat tab) Hard to follow chats (in relation to current time)
4. (nice to have) When tapping on a segment, add some minimal visual cue to make it super clear that an action was taken, more noticeable on web due to lag

Video Specific

1. Bring playback speed setting (.5x, 2x) to surface level (next to volume)
2. (Mobile) Can we improve video PIP (ability to browse cambly app while video keeps playing as a small overlay)
 - a. Don't pause when switching
 - b. Can we make PIP smaller?
 - c. Return to full screen just closes video
 - i. (Should take you back to lesson playback surface)